The About Me Handoff Checklist

What to ask your wife, write down and hand to her new caregivers.

New caregivers start this week. They'll have your wife's chart. The tea before anything else, the radio in the kitchen, the name she likes to be called: those are still with you. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is simply still to do.

Ask

- [ ] Ask her to describe a good day, and write down what she says, the way she says it. [1]
- [ ] Ask which of her routines matter most to her during this change.
- [ ] Ask what helps when she's somewhere unfamiliar, or with people she doesn't know yet.
- [ ] Ask how she likes to be spoken to, starting with the name she wants to be called.
- [ ] Ask what she'd like the new team to know about her, and whether there's anything she'd rather leave off the page. [1]

Write

- [ ] Her usual morning and evening, in the order things happen: when she wakes, what comes first, how the day winds down.
- [ ] What she likes to eat and drink, and when she usually eats.
- [ ] On a separate list: any allergy or dietary instruction a clinician has given you, with who gave it and when. Keep it apart from her likes and dislikes.
- [ ] The activities she enjoys and the people who matter to her.
- [ ] A mark beside anything you filled in yourself and she hasn't confirmed yet.

Share

- [ ] Read the page back to her where possible, and change whatever she says is wrong.
- [ ] Make a short version for the people who will be with her, with only what she's agreed to share.
- [ ] Find out who on the new team will receive it and review it, and write down their name.
- [ ] Put the date on it, and who wrote it.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you ask, write down and hand over. It doesn't say what any of her preferences should mean for her care, turn a like or dislike into an instruction, or fill in what she hasn't said. Those belong to her and to the people who assess her, and to the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've asked her, written it down and found out who receives it. The care interview takes the same care with the rest of her situation: it walks you through her preferences alongside her care needs and the people who support her, area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The items marked 1 follow questions in The Conversation Project's What Matters to Me workbook; the rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. The Conversation Project (Institute for Healthcare Improvement) and Ariadne Labs, What Matters to Me: A Workbook for Better Health Care